

Throughout the Official Basketball Rules the text applies equally to all genders and shall be read accordingly.

RULE ONE – THE GAME

Article 1 Definitions

1.1 Basketball game

Basketball is played by 2 teams of 5 players each. The aim of each team is to score in the opponents' basket and to prevent the other team from scoring.

The game is conducted by the referees, table officials and a commissioner, if present.

Whenever the role of "commissioner" is referenced, it also applies to the role of "technical delegate".

1.2 Participants' responsibility

All participants in the game, table officials, commissioners, if present, all team members entitled to play, head coaches and other accompanying delegation members should play a positive role in the smooth running of the game and are expected to always demonstrate ethical behaviour. Should they become aware of an inaccuracy (correctable error) in scorekeeping involving the score, fouls, time-outs as well as the timekeeping and shot clock operations, they are expected to notify the referees immediately to ensure and facilitate the error to be corrected in accordance with these rules.

1.3 Basket: opponents'/own

The basket that is attacked by a team is the opponents' basket and the basket which is defended by a team is its own basket.

1.4 Winner of a game

The team that has scored the greater number of points at the end of playing time shall be the winner.

RULE TWO – COURT AND EQUIPMENT

Article 2 Court

2.1 Court

The court shall have a flat, hard surface free from obstructions (Diagram 1) with dimensions of 28 m in length by 15 m in width measured from the inner edge of the boundary line.

2.2 Floor

The floor shall include the court area surrounded by a further boundary lane free from obstructions with a minimum of 2 m in width (Diagram 2). Therefore, the floor shall have dimensions of a minimum of 32 m in length and a minimum of 19 m in width.

2.3 Backcourt

A team's backcourt consists of its team's own basket, the inbounds part of the backboard and that part of the court limited by the endline behind its own basket, the sidelines and the centre line.

2.4 Frontcourt

A team's frontcourt consists of the opponents' basket, the inbounds part of the backboard and that part of the court limited by the endline behind the opponents' basket, the sidelines and the inner edge of the centre line nearest to the opponents' basket.

2.5 Lines

All lines shall be of a solid colour, 5 cm in width, clearly visible and in high contrast with the colour(s) of the playing court and the further boundary lane.

The colours of the boundary lines and other court markings may differ, however, the following principle must apply:

- All boundary lines, including sidelines, end lines, throw-in lines and team bench area lines must be of the same colour.
- The colour of each pair of other court markings must match on both half-courts. These include:
 - Restricted areas, including free throw lines and free-throw rebound places
 - Free throw semi-circles
 - 3-point lines
 - No-charge semi-circles
- The centre line and the centre circle may be of a different colour than the boundary lines and other court markings. The centre line and the centre circle, between each other, may be of the same colour or of different colours.

2.5.1 Boundary line

The court shall be limited by the boundary line, consisting of the endlines and the sidelines. These lines are not part of the court.

Any obstruction including seated head coach, first assistant coach, substitutes, excluded players and accompanying delegation members shall be at least 2 m from the court.

2.5.2 Centre line, centre circle and free-throw semi-circles

The centre line shall be marked parallel to the endlines from the mid-point of the sidelines. It shall extend 0.15 m beyond each sideline. The centre line is part of the backcourt.

The centre circle shall be marked in the centre of the court and have a radius of 1.80 m measured to the outer edge of the circumference.

The free-throw semi-circles shall be marked on the court with a radius of 1.80 m measured to the outer edge of the circumference and with their centres at the mid-point of the free-throw lines (Diagram 3).

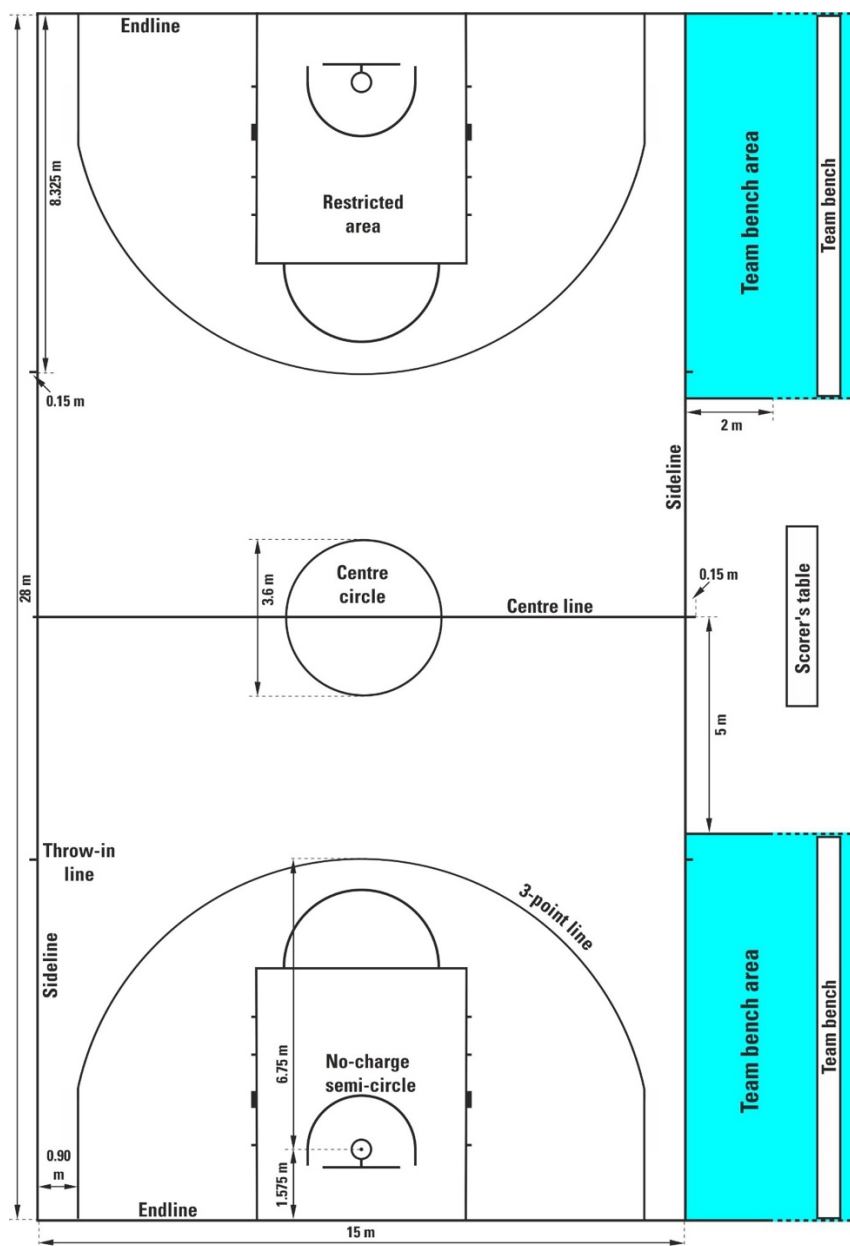


Diagram 1 Full size court

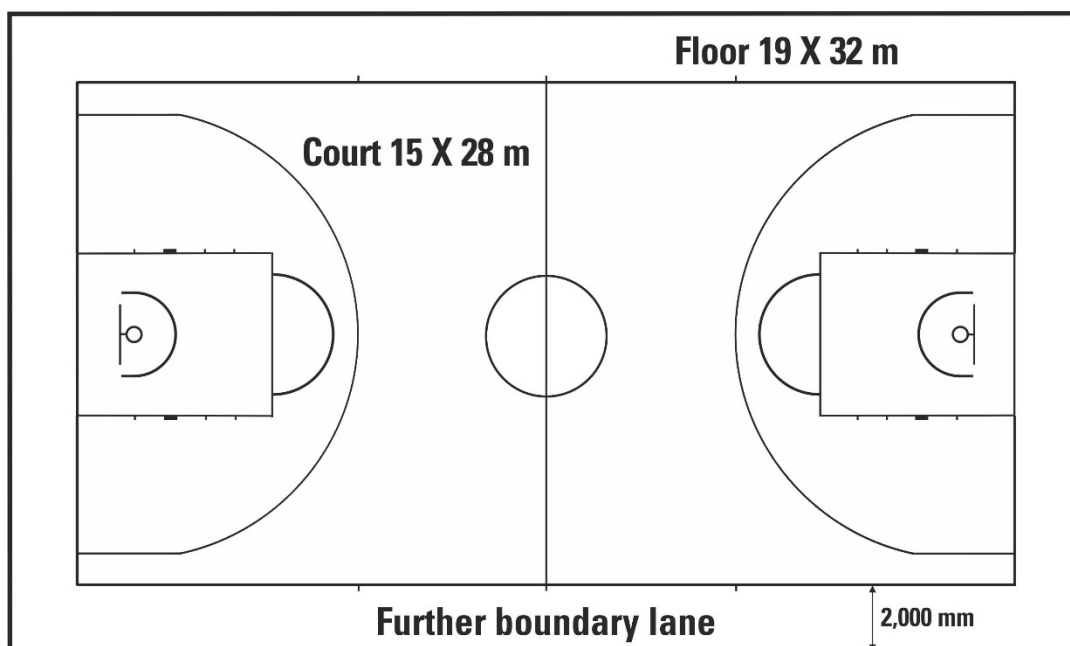


Diagram 2 Court and floor

2.5.3 Free-throw lines, restricted areas and free-throw rebound places

The free-throw line shall be marked parallel to each endline. It shall have its furthest edge 5.80 m from the inner edge of the endline and shall be 3.60 m long. Its mid-point shall lie on the imaginary line joining the mid-point of the 2 endlines.

The restricted areas shall be the rectangular areas marked on the court limited by the endlines, the extended free-throw lines and the lines which originate at the endlines, their outer edges being 2.45 m from the mid-point of the endlines and terminating at the outer edge of the extended free-throw lines. These lines, excluding the endlines, are part of the restricted area.

Free-throw rebound places along the restricted areas, reserved for players during free throws, shall be marked as in Diagram 3.

2.5.4 3-point goal area

The team's 3-point goal area (Diagram 1 and Diagram 4) shall be the entire court area, except for the area near the opponents' basket, limited by and including:

- The 2 parallel lines extending from and perpendicular to the endline, with the outer edge 0.90 m from the inner edge of the sidelines.
- An arc of radius 6.75 m measured from the point on the court beneath the exact centre of the opponents' basket to the outer edge of the arc. The distance of the point on the court from the inner edge of the mid-point of the endline is 1.575 m. The arc is joined to the parallel lines.

The 3-point line is not part of the 3-point goal area.

2.5.5 Team bench areas

The team bench areas shall be marked outside the court limited by 2 lines as in Diagram 1.

There must be 16 seats available in each team bench area for the head coach, the substitutes, the excluded players and the accompanying delegation members including assistant coaches. Any other persons shall be located at least 2 m behind the team bench.